

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Connected frontier polities, not one invasion wave

BACTRIA / OXUS / CENTRAL ASIA

- |-- Indo-Greeks -> Gandhara, Punjab and selected eastern routes
- |-- Shakas -> Taxila, Mathura, western India and upper Deccan
- |-- Pahlavas -> Afghanistan-Gandhara frontier
- `-- Great Yuezhi -> Bactria -> Kushana consolidation

SIMULTANEOUS: Shunga/Kanva, Satavahana and Tamil polities

Groups overlapped in time and space; they were not one dynasty.

Origin, political territory and later cultural affiliation must be separated.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Indo-Greek political and numismatic profile

GRECO-BACTRIAN EXPANSION SOUTH OF HINDU KUSH

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regional Indo-Greek kingdoms and competing rulers

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portrait coins + Greek/Kharosthi legends + deities + monograms

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ruler sequence, titulature, minting and cross-cultural communication

LIMIT: coin distribution maps circulation better than exact sovereign borders.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Menander and Heliodorus: two contact mechanisms

MENANDER / MILINDA

Indo-Greek ruler

Milindapanho dialogue

Buddhist memory and debate

literary text with layers

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-- cultural participation through different institutions

Neither case proves uniform conversion of an entire people.

HELIODORUS PILLAR

envoy of Antialcidas

Bhagabhadra court at Besnagar

Vasudeva devotion and diplomacy

inscriptional diplomatic evidence

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## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Shakas, Pahlavas and Kshatrapa rule

SHAKA MOVEMENTS -> regional branches and satrapal/kshatrapa titles

Maues / Azes traditions -> north-western sequences

Rajuvula and successors -> Mathura sphere

Nahapana / Kshaharata -> western India and Satavahana conflict

Chashtana / Rudradaman -> Western Kshatrapa consolidation

PAHLAVA / INDO-PARTHIAN -> Gondophares and frontier rule

TRAP: Nahapana and Rudradaman belong to different Shaka branches.

Use inscription and coin chronology; avoid one neat replacement queue.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Kushana formation and chronology

GREAT YUEZHI MOVEMENT -> BACTRIA -> GUISHUANG / KUSHANA

Kujula Kadphises -> consolidation

Vima Takto / Soter Megas -> debated identification

Vima Kadphises -> gold and Shaiva imagery

Kanishka I -> commonly c. 127 CE, not automatically 78 CE

Huvishka -> Vasudeva -> later Kushana phases

Rabatak inscription helps ruler order and imperial self-definition.

Separate Shaka Era 78 CE from Kanishka's currently favoured chronology.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Kushana political geography and governance

BACTRIA / BEGRAM

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PURUSHAPURA / GANDHARA ---- TAXILA ---- PUNJAB

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+----- MATHURA -----+

multi-centred nodes + subordinate rulers + kshatrapa/official titles

Devaputra and royal imagery express exalted sovereignty.

A networked empire need not possess uniform districts or one capital.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Coins, trade and route participation

SILK-ROUTE BRANCHES + INDIAN OCEAN LINKS + INNER-ASIAN CORRIDORS

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gold and copper coinage + customs + caravan/urban demand

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merchants, guilds, monasteries, ports and political nodes

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high-value monetary capacity and transregional exchange

LIMIT: gold coins do not prove universal prosperity or exclusive route control.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Religious plurality and Buddhist patronage

COINS: Iranian, Greek, Indian and Buddhist deities across rulers

MONUMENTS: Buddhist stupas and monasteries in Gandhara and Mathura worlds

KANISHKA MEMORY: major Buddhist patron and council traditions

MAHAYANA: longer doctrinal-social development, not one ruler's invention

MATHURA: Buddhist, Jaina, Brahmanical and royal images

ROYAL POLICY: plural engagement and legitimation across constituencies

Personal belief cannot be reconstructed from one coin or later legend.

Patronage, public iconography and doctrinal origin are different questions.



## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Gandhara and Mathura compared

### GANDHARA

grey schist and stucco  
layered Hellenised forms  
Buddhist narrative prominence  
drapery and body modelling

### MATHURA

red sandstone  
older local sculptural idioms  
Buddhist, Jaina, Brahmanical and royal range  
frontal force and indigenous conventions

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\-- interaction, workshops and Kushana patronage --/

Neither school was pure, isolated or merely a copy of the other.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Language, script and knowledge exchange

GREEK + KHAROSTHI on Indo-Greek and north-western coins

BACTRIAN in Greek script in Kushana royal usage

PRAKRIT-BRAHMI across many Indian inscriptions

SANSKRIT courtly expansion in Rudradaman's Junagadh inscription

ASTRAL KNOWLEDGE: selective Greek vocabulary/textual influence

DIPLOMACY/RELIGION: Heliodorus and multilingual royal communication

Exchange transformed imported forms through local languages and institutions.

Do not infer ethnicity directly from script or single technical term.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Mutual impact, adaptation and decline

INCOMING: coin portraiture, titles, artistic forms and route connections

LOCAL: languages, religions, political offices and patronage networks

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reciprocal adaptation and legitimation

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regional identities persist; power and exchange remain unequal

DECLINE: Sasanian pressure in west + regional successors + changing routes

VERDICT: 'Indianisation' is negotiated synthesis, not one-way cultural surrender.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Examiner-ready Central Asian contacts spine

INTRO: separate Indo-Greeks, Shakas, Pahlavas and Kushanas by time and region.

BODY 1: routes, political chronology and evidence classes

BODY 2: coins, titles, governance and trade networks

BODY 3: religion, Gandhara-Mathura art and language exchange

BODY 4: reciprocal adaptation, regional variation and chronology disputes

COUNTER: coin-distribution limits, later traditions and 'foreign' essentialism

CONCLUSION: contact produced durable synthesis without erasing difference.

WRITE: group -> ruler/source -> region -> mechanism -> impact -> limit.